RVAcheapFLIGHTS

How a Richmond fare becomes a deal

The method, the reasoning, and what a subscriber actually receives · 255 graded fares, Aug 17 – Oct 19, 2026

THE PROCESS

Every fare out of RIC goes through the same four steps. Nothing is hand-picked.

STEP 1
Watch
Fares out of Richmond arrive continuously and are graded five times a day, at 4am, 8am, noon, 4pm and 8pm Eastern. 255 fares graded across 26 airports in 64 days.

STEP 2
Compare
Each fare is measured against Google's own published typical price range for that exact trip — same route, same travel dates, captured at the same moment the fare is found. Not a flat dollar threshold.

STEP 3
Grade
How far the fare sits below that range sets a 1–10 grade. A nonstop earns a small bonus, two or more stops a small penalty.

STEP 4
Publish
Grade 7 and above goes to subscribers, highest first, up to three per edition. Anything left over waits for the next edition rather than being dropped.

WHY IT IS BUILT THIS WAY

Why each route is judged against itself

$575 to Rome and $98 to Charleston are not comparable numbers. A fare is only meaningful against what that particular route normally costs, so every route is scored on its own terms.

Why Google's range, not an average of our own

The range is captured with each fare, so it already reflects that trip's travel dates, booking lead time and season. A single stored "normal price" per route goes stale and cannot tell a Thanksgiving week from a quiet one.

Why the bar sits below the middle

A fare in the middle of the typical range is an ordinary good price, not a find. The threshold is set deliberately toward the cheap end of the range so an ordinary price never gets called a deal.

WHAT A SUBSCRIBER CAN EXPECT

Measured over the 64 days above. 46 of those days produced at least one fare that cleared the bar — and on 58 days a fare of any kind was logged, so 58 is the realistic ceiling.

46/64	3–6	3 days	up to 3	84
days carried a qualifying fare (72%)	editions a week no week below 3	longest gap between editions, all period	fares per edition 20 ×1 · 14 ×2 · 12 ×3	qualifying fares, all 84 delivered

WHAT THE DATA SHOWED, AUG 17 – OCT 19

Each route's average distance from its own typical price. Some of the strongest results are not where people expect them, and some short hops are consistently poor value out of Richmond.

BEST VALUE FROM RIC	VS TYPICAL	WEAKEST VALUE FROM RIC	VS TYPICAL
Charleston	51% below	Boston	34% above
Fort Myers	46% below	Miami	25% above
Nashville	35% below	New York (LaGuardia)	22% above
Tampa	27% below	Fort Lauderdale	16% above
Las Vegas	25% below	Newark	15% above
Chicago (Midway)	21% below	Montego Bay	12% above

About these numbers. 255 fares out of RIC observed and graded between Aug 17 and Oct 19, 2026, across 26 airports. Each fare is real and was seen on the date recorded; airfare moves constantly, so a price is accurate as of that date rather than today. 64 days is a genuine sample but not a seasonal one, and these figures should not be read as a year-round pattern. Percentages are each route's average distance from the typical price range published for that trip at the time it was found. Fare-level data available on request.

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